

Defensible evidence

Why our reports refuse to guess, and why that is the point on a job where the document ends up on a table between two parties.

WHAT USUALLY HAPPENS

Software that reads photographs will give you **an answer for every photograph**. Ask it about a shot that shows nothing useful and it still returns a confident line, because a blank answer reads as the tool having failed.

So the report looks complete, and one of its lines is a guess. On a schedule of condition or a due-diligence report, that is the line the other side finds.

WHAT WE DO INSTEAD

It will not guess

Where the evidence does not support a judgement, the item is marked **not assessed** and says so on the page. It does not resolve to a pass.

It may only cite a standard that is on its list - **12**

Approved Documents, 6 British and EN standards, 6 HSE instruments. Nothing off that list is ever cited, and if nothing on the list fits, it cites nothing at all.

A person has to resolve it

The report **cannot be issued** while anything is unresolved. A named person confirms, corrects or deletes each item, and each item needs a trade before it can go.

Publishing freezes the document: the issued version keeps its reference and its date, and a change starts a new version rather than editing the old one.

WHY IT MATTERS HERE

A snagging list is a to-do list - speed is the point, and a machine filling in every line is welcome. A **schedule of condition or a dilapidations report is not a list, it is a position**: it gets used at lease exit, in negotiation, in provision reporting, sometimes in front of a lawyer.

One invented line and the document stops being evidence. An item that openly says *not assessed, and here is why* - resolved by a person, with the photograph, the time, the place and the capture details attached - is the thing that survives being challenged.

WHAT HOLDS IT UP

THE RULE	WHAT IT MEANS IN THE REPORT
Not assessed	Anything the evidence cannot support is flagged for a person, never resolved to a pass
Citation ceiling	Only the listed standards may be cited; no invented clauses and no guessed paragraph numbers
Evidence attached	Every photograph carries its own time, place and capture details, and every finding sits on the photograph it came from
Confirmed by a person	The report will not issue with an unassessed item in it, and every item carries a trade
Frozen on issue	The issued version never changes afterwards; a correction becomes a new version with its own reference

WHAT IT DOES NOT DO

Read this before relying on the output

- It does not decide engineering. It describes what the photograph shows; severity and sign-off are a person's call.
- It is not a drawing tool - no CAD, no BIM, and it does not replace a measured survey.

- It cannot assess what was not photographed, and it will say so rather than fill the gap.
- It does not send anything by itself. Distribution is a person's decision.
- It is not a substitute for professional judgement, and it is not a certification of compliance.

If a report has to survive being challenged, the honest blank is worth more than the confident guess.

Photographs in, a referenced report out - drafted by the machine, resolved and issued by a person.

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